

Windows 11 26H2: what matters

A small update that switches on features already delivered to 24H2 and 25H2, turns some on by default for business PCs, and resets the support clock.

Checked against Microsoft Learn
October 2026

RELEASED

September 29, 2026

Gradual rollout through Windows Update

DELIVERED AS

Enablement package

From 24H2 or 25H2 · one restart

LIFECYCLE

Support clock resets

Like every annual feature update

DEADLINE

October 13, 2026

24H2 Home and Pro end of support

 On by default for business PCs

✓ Windows settings backup — existing admin policies still win

✓ App-specific taskbar actions

✓ File Explorer navigation improvements

 Security

✓ Administrator protection — just-in-time admin rights (off by default)

✓ Built-in Sysmon (off by default)

✓ Smart App Control toggles without a reinstall

 Recovery

✓ Point-in-time restore rolls back apps, settings and files

✓ Quick machine recovery — off on managed PCs unless enabled

✓ First sign-in restore for hybrid joined PCs and Cloud PCs

 For users

✓ Redesigned Start; taskbar on any screen edge

✓ Copilot key remaps to Right Ctrl or Menu

✓ Accessibility — Magnifier tint, Narrator Braille Viewer, smarter Voice access

Before you deploy

Test in a pilot ring first

Cross-signed drivers

No longer trusted by default — audit legacy hardware drivers.

WMIC removed

Not even as a Feature on Demand. Move scripts to CIM cmdlets.

File History fixed

Fixed in September 22, 2026 and later updates.